

Hardik Gaikwad

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EDUCATION

Jabalpur Engineering College — B.Tech in Information Technology

2023 – 2027

CGPA: 7.69 (up to 6th Semester)

Jabalpur, India

Bal Bhavan School — CBSE

Class XII: 90.8%, Class X: 90.2%

SKILLS

Languages: Python, C++, Bash, SQL

Security Tools: Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, Hydra, Gobuster, Nikto

Frameworks & Databases: Django, Django REST Framework

Platforms & Environments: Linux, Windows, macOS, VMware, VirtualBox

Security: OWASP Top 10, Web Application Pentesting, Network Enumeration, Exploitation, Privilege Escalation

PROJECTS

PrivShare — **End-to-End Encrypted File Sharing** (GitHub) | (Live Demo) | *Python, Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, AWS S3*

- Built a zero-knowledge file-sharing app with client-side AES-GCM-256 E2EE using pycryptodome; the server never receives or stores the decryption key.
- Offloaded encrypted blob storage to AWS S3 via django-storages and served downloads as StreamingHttpResponse, supporting files up to 200MB without loading into server memory.
- Secured access with UUID4 tokens against IDOR attacks, GCM authentication tags for tamper detection, and automated 6-hour file expiry via background tasks.

XSScan — **Context-Aware Reflected XSS Scanner** (GitHub)

- Developed an automated, async vulnerability scanner that maps domain-scoped targets and fuzzes GET/POST input vectors using context-specific payloads (HTML, JS, SVG, attributes).
- Engineered a resilient detection engine that parses HTTP responses into DOM trees to guarantee injected payloads execute unescaped in the browser context.
- Architected a scalable testing pipeline with configurable rate-limiting, connection pooling, and custom header support for assessing authenticated endpoints.

Home Cybersecurity Lab & Network Simulation Environment | *pfSense, Kali Linux, VMware*

- Built a virtualized cybersecurity lab using VMware, configuring pfSense as a firewall and router to create segmented attacker and target networks.
- Deployed vulnerable machines from platforms including VulnHub, OWASP Broken Web Applications and DVWA alongside a Kali Linux attacker machine to perform end-to-end penetration testing, including enumeration, exploitation, and privilege escalation.

GetPYQJEC — **Crowd-Sourced PYQ Compilation Platform** (GitHub) | *Django, React (Vite), pikepdf*

- Led backend development in a team to address fragmented access to academic resources; architected a Django REST API powering a React (Vite) frontend that centralizes Previous Year Question Papers for the entire college.
- Implemented structured file storage and on-demand PDF compilation using **pikepdf**, enabling students to generate subject-wise or semester-wise PYQ bundles by year range, eliminating manual compilation effort.

CERTIFICATIONS

eJPT (eLearnSecurity Junior Penetration Tester) — Certificate

- Conducted full kill-chain penetration tests across multiple network services, executing reconnaissance, enumeration, vulnerability identification, exploitation, and post-exploitation in segmented lab environments.
- Performed hands-on assessments involving credential attacks, misconfiguration exploitation, privilege escalation, and lateral movement through pivoting across subnet boundaries.

TryHackMe Security Learning Paths — Profile (Global Top 4%)

- Ranked in the global top 4% on TryHackMe; completed Pre Security, Cyber Security 101, and Jr Penetration Tester paths covering networking fundamentals, exploitation techniques, and web application attacks.

VOLUNTEERING

VulnCon - Security Conference (Core Team Member) — Contributed to video editing and media content creation, served as the POC between the Media and Social Media teams, guided photographers and videographers for event coverage, and supported on-site event coordination.